

OWEN ‘KARL’ HILL

GAME DESIGNER

I'm a passionate game designer and a graduate with a BSc in Games Design from The Manchester Metropolitan University. I'm focused on creating engaging, systems-driven experiences that balance gameplay depth with artistic cohesion. I enjoy bringing ideas from concept to implementation, with a strong interest in player experience, iteration, and polished, immersive design.

EXPERIENCE

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

MANCHESTER METROPOLITAN UNIVERSITY

3D Character Artist / UI Artist / Programmer

CheddarCat | Hellcaster | Sep 2025 - Jan 2026

- Worked on a **12-person project** in a simulated game studio, utilizing **GitHub** and **Jira** to work under an **agile workflow**.
- Designed and implemented Player HUD elements, contributing to the clarity and usability of core gameplay systems.
- Contributed to 3D character pipelines, including modeling, texturing, rigging, and animation.
- Showcased the project at **MCM Birmingham Comic-Con** and **EGX**, where we observed playtests of our game and networked with industry professionals.
- Received a grade of 82%.**

Team Lead, Gameplay Designer, UI & Shader Artist

Co-Lab 5 | Nun With a Gun | Sep 2025 - Jan 2026

- Led a **cross-disciplinary development team of 7**, coordinating the overall project development.
- Designed and developed the core gameplay loop.
- Contributed to the game's unique art style by integrating stylish shaders and UI elements.
- Consolidated the team's work into a **Unity** project using **GitHub**.
- Achieved an 85%**, with tutor feedback citing strong leadership, collaboration, and a high level of technical and creative problem-solving.

Level Designer, Game Designer & Narrative Designer

Environment & Level Design | Metal Gear Solid: 2 (DLC) | Sep 2024 - Jan 2025

- Designed a small mission in **Unreal Engine 5** to function as a DLC for MGS2.
- Developed a **narrative** to match the source game's tone and writing style.
- Used **level & game design** principles to recreate mechanics and to match the source game's pacing and difficulty.
- Created a playable blackout** with a fully written narrative, cutscenes, lighting, and game mechanics.
- Received a grade of 90%.**

Game Designer & Developer

Rapid Game Prototyping: Game a week | Jan 2025 - April 2025

- Developed **six game prototypes**, each one **completed in a 1-week time frame** and each constrained by a unique theme.
- Rapidly iterated** on core gameplay loops.
- Explored a wide range of **genres and mechanics** in a fast-paced development cycle.
- Tested gameplay systems independently, **improving efficiency in prototyping and decision-making**.

CONTACT DETAILS

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SKILLS & SOFTWARE

Engines:

- [Unity \(C#, ShaderGraph\)](#)
- [Unreal Engine \(Blueprints\)](#)

Design Tools:

- [Photoshop](#)
- [Substance Painter](#)
- [Blender](#)
- [Aseprite](#)

Production Tools:

- [Miro, Jira](#)
- [GitHub](#)
- [Git Bash](#)

Misc:

- [Linux \(Arch, Ubuntu\)](#)
- [HTML / CSS / JS](#)

- [System & Gameplay Design](#)
- [Team Collaboration](#)
- [Agile Scrum workflow](#)
- [3D Character Design](#)
- [Quick Prototyping & Iteration](#)

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

Invited to a game showcase.

- MCM Birmingham Comic-Con** indie games booth (2025) and **EGX**.

3x 'Game of the Week' winner.

- Three times 'Game of the Week' winner, during MMU's Cheddarcat module.

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Games Design

Manchester Metropolitan University

Sept 2023 - Jul 2026

- (Predicted first-class)

NextGen: Games, Animation & VFX

Doncaster College

Sept 2021 - Jul 2023

- High-Merit

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Team Lead

Doncaster College | Feb 2022 - May 2022

- **Led a cross-disciplinary team** in designing a dedicated student social and gaming space, fostering community and engagement on campus.
- Oversaw project timelines, delegated tasks, and ensured milestones were met efficiently.
- **Pitched concepts to clients**, gathered and implemented feedback to align with user needs and expectations.
- Strengthened key professional skills, **including leadership, time management, collaboration, and client communication.**